

THE WEAPON

The three terrorists, sources claim, used US-made M4 Carbine assault rifles. The M4 is a 5.56×45mm NATO, select-fire, gas-operated, magazine-fed assault rifle and carbine, which has been described as "one of the defining firearms of the 21st century"



THE ATTACKERS*

Officials suspect foreign terrorist groups that have attacked the Indian army in Poonch and Rajouri since 2021. The LeT-sponsored shadow group, The Resistance Front, initially claimed responsibility only to retract it later

**Sketch of one of the terrorists released by the police*

9
KILLED
(4 from Rajasthan, including a two-year-old boy; 3 from Uttar Pradesh besides the driver from Reasi and the conductor from Katra)

41
INJURED

Target Jammu

There has been a surge in terror attacks in the region in recent times. The latest attack on June 12 evening at a joint police and security forces check post in Doda district left six security personnel injured. Earlier that day, a CRPF soldier was killed in Kathua district in an encounter in which two terrorists were neutralised

WHY REASI?

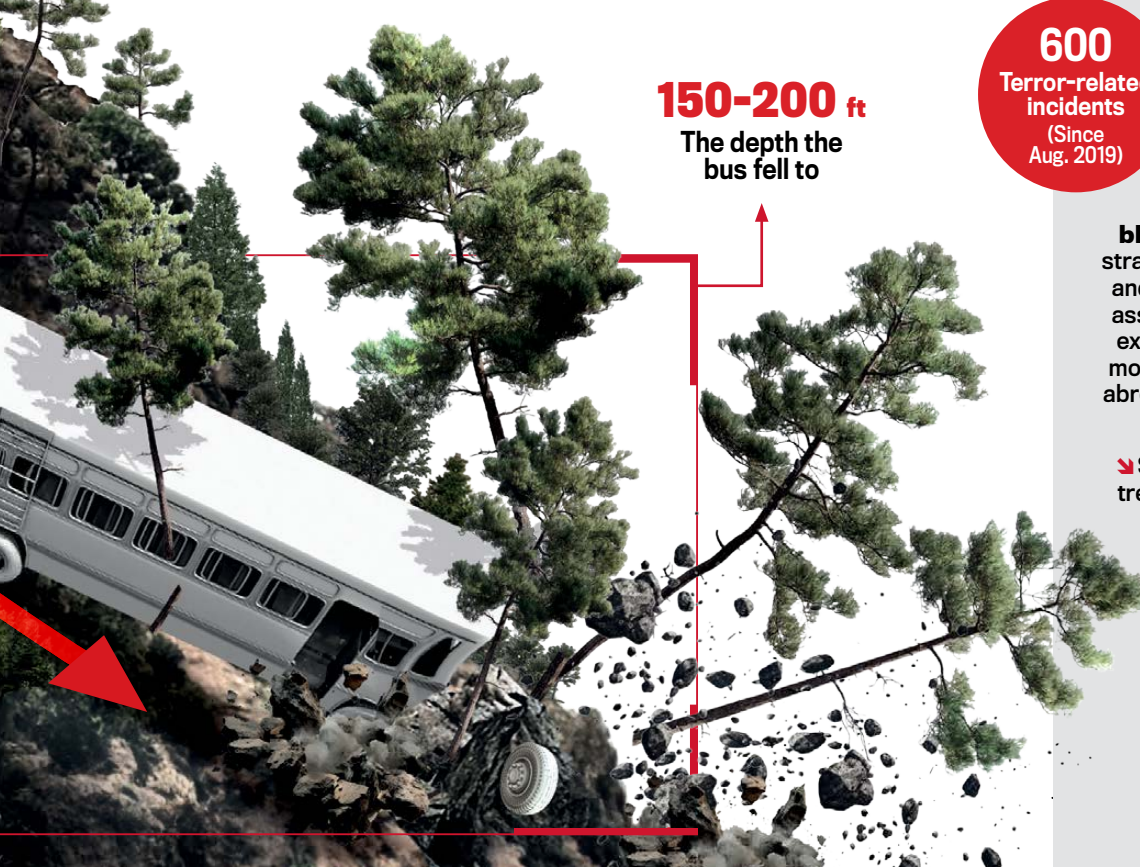
Reasi, Rajouri, and Poonch districts have dense forests and rugged mountain terrain. Along the porous LoC, Rajouri and Poonch offer easy access for terrorists from Pakistan. Reasi also acts as a transit route for those moving towards the Kashmir Valley

RELIGIOUS TOURISM HUB

Reasi is a key religious tourism destination in the Jammu region. Pilgrims visiting the Vaishno Devi shrine mostly extend their trip to the Shiv Khori temple, which draws nearly two million visitors every year

WHY IT'S WORRYING

The recent attacks have set alarm bells ringing within the security grid ahead of the Amarnath Yatra, scheduled from June 29 to August 19. During this time, thousands trek the steep mountain path to the remote Pahalgam cave shrine



600
Terror-related incidents
(Since Aug. 2019)

TOLL
(Since Aug. 2019)
150 Civilians
687 Terrorists
242 Security personnel

PAKISTAN'S NEW GAME OF TERROR

Four militant attacks–apparently directed from across the border–since June 9 in the usually 'peaceful' Jammu sector have taken India's security establishment by surprise. Here's why Pakistan has suddenly turned up the heat on India

Provoke India: By upping the ante, Pakistan aims to test the resolve of the Indian government. It also wants to send a message that despite Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the NDA government's electoral success, Jammu and Kashmir remains beyond their control

Foment communal tensions: Targeting the Hindu-majority Jammu region, the hostile neighbour intends to incite communal tensions just before the Amarnath Yatra

Stall the assembly election: The clear strategy is to create unrest and disrupt the upcoming assembly election in J&K, expected in the next few months, the first since the abrogation of Article 370 in August 2019

Shift focus: The centre of gravity has moved towards the less-militarised areas of Jammu, as the Indian Army's intensified operations have limited the space for terrorists to act in the Kashmir Valley

–Pradip R. Sagar